BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #71 · SERVING GOD WITH LIMITS

“God can't use me in this condition.”

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Where it often comes from

Illness can erase roles in ministry, work, and family. When we cannot do what we used to do, we may feel set aside by God.

What Scripture teaches

“God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong.” “My power is perfected in weakness.” Moses said, “I have never been eloquent… I am slow of speech and tongue,” and God replied, “Who gave man his mouth?… Now go!” (Exodus 4:10–12). Gideon called his clan the weakest, and God said, “I will be with you.” Paul’s thorn became a platform for God’s power. God uses limited people because the power is His.

> *“But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong”* (1 Corinthians 1:27).

Also see

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> “‘Please, Lord,’ Moses replied, ‘I have never been eloquent, neither in the past nor since You have spoken to Your servant, for I am slow of speech and tongue.’ And the LORD said to him, ‘Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD? Now go! I will help you as you speak, and I will teach you what to say.’” (Exodus 4:10–12).

> “‘Please, my Lord,’ Gideon replied, ‘how can I save Israel? Indeed, my clan is the weakest in Manasseh, and I am the youngest in my father’s house.’” (Judges 6:15).

> “The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands” (Psalm 138:8).

Common self-statements

- I am too limited.
- God needs strong people.
- I have been set aside.
- I can’t do what I used to.
- My usefulness is over.
- There is nothing I can offer.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing God uses only the strong or no one.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never serve again.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling limited and concluding that I am unusable.
- Labeling: Calling myself unusable.

Challenging questions

- What have I told myself God needs from me?
- Whom did God use in Scripture who felt weak or limited?
- What can I still do: pray, encourage, write, listen?
- Who needs what I can give?
- What does Scripture say about power in weakness?
- What is one small service this week?

Truth summary

> God does not need my strength. He works through weak and limited people to display His power. I can serve in ways that fit my condition.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Will of God
- Humility
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God can't use me in this condition"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God can't use me in this condition." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I told myself God needs from me?
- ☐ Whom did God use in Scripture who felt weak or limited?
- ☐ What can I still do: pray, encourage, write, listen?
- ☐ Who needs what I can give?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about power in weakness?
- ☐ What is one small service this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God chooses the weak.
- ☐ His power is perfected in weakness.
- ☐ He told Moses, "Now go."
- ☐ He will fulfill His purpose for me.
- ☐ I can serve within my limits.
- ☐ Small service counts.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 1:27
  "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ Exodus 4:10–12
  "'Please, Lord,' Moses replied, 'I have never been eloquent, neither in the past nor since You have spoken to Your servant, for I am slow of speech and tongue.' And the LORD said to him, 'Who gave man his mouth? Or who makes the mute or the deaf, the sighted or the blind? Is it not I, the LORD? Now go! I will help you as you speak, and I will teach you what to say.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Serving within limits: Each week, note one way you served.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Corinthians 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His power is made perfect in weakness.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List what you can do. Write ways to serve within your limits.
- [ ] Pray for others. Choose a few people.
- [ ] Send encouragement. A card, call, or message.
- [ ] Ask your church. Find a fitting role.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God can't use me in this condition": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Serving within limits
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God can't use me in this condition.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel set aside. Show me how to serve within my limits, and display Your power in my weakness. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.